# Commas & Apostrophes (Set B)

Year 5 Accelerated · **Homework Worksheet**

## Worked Example

**Worked Example:** Explain the difference between 'its' and 'it's', and use each correctly in a sentence.

**Answer:** 'Its' is possessive (shows something belongs to it), e.g. 'The dog wagged its tail.' 'It's' is a contraction of 'it is' or 'it has', e.g. 'It's raining today.'

## Purple — Getting Started (15 questions)

1. Add commas to this list: 'We bought bread milk cheese and jam.'
2. Rewrite using an apostrophe for the missing letters: 'I have not seen that film.' (shorten 'have not')
3. Which sentence uses commas correctly in a list? A) The bag held pens, pencils, and, rulers. B) The bag held pens pencils and rulers. C) The bag held pens, pencils and rulers. D) The bag, held pens pencils and rulers. E) The bag held, pens, pencils and rulers.
4. Write the possessive form: the scarf belonging to Aisha.
5. Underline the apostrophe's job (contraction or possession) in: 'The bird's nest fell from the tree.'
6. Underline the apostrophe's job (contraction or possession) in: 'We didn't finish the race.'
7. Select ALL that apply. Which of these words correctly use an apostrophe for a contraction? A) wasn't B) boys' C) haven't D) she's E) cats
8. Add a comma to separate the direct address in: 'Please close the door Aunty.'
9. Which sentence correctly shows possession for one cat? A) The cats bowl was empty. B) The cat's bowl was empty. C) The cats' bowl was empty. D) The cat,s bowl was empty. E) The ca't's bowl was empty.
10. Rewrite showing possession: the lockers belonging to the whole team (more than one player).
11. Add commas to this list: 'The box contained books pencils rulers and crayons.'
12. Which word correctly shows that something belongs to more than one doctor? A) doctors B) doctor's C) doctors' D) doctors's E) doctor,s
13. Write a sentence using the contraction 'you're' correctly.
14. Explain the difference in meaning between 'the girl's coat' and 'the girls' coat'.
15. Select ALL that apply. Which of these sentences correctly use a comma before a name in direct address? A) Hello, Mr Khan. B) Hello Mr, Khan. C) Please help me Omar. D) Please help me, Omar. E) Goodnight Grandma sleep well.

## Green — Building Fluency (15 questions)

1. Punctuate correctly: 'Even though she was scared Lily climbed the ladder.'
2. Explain why a comma is needed after 'Even though she was scared' in the sentence above.
3. Which sentence uses a comma correctly after a fronted adverbial? A) Suddenly without warning the alarm sounded. B) Suddenly, without warning the alarm sounded. C) Suddenly, without warning, the alarm sounded. D) Suddenly without, warning the alarm sounded. E) Suddenly without warning the alarm, sounded.
4. Write the correct possessive for: the leads belonging to several dogs.

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5. Explain why 'the men's locker room' uses an apostrophe before the s even though 'men' is already plural.

6. Select ALL that apply. Which of these sentences use commas correctly to mark a clause in the middle of a sentence? A) My aunt, who lives in Leeds, is visiting. B) My aunt who, lives in Leeds is visiting. C) The car, that we saw, was expensive. D) The cake which Dad baked, was lovely. E) The parrot, a noisy bird, squawked all day.

7. Correct this sentence: 'Its been snowing since last night so wrap up warm.'

8. Which sentence correctly punctuates a list that includes a describing phrase? A) We saw elephants, giraffes, and zebras, at the park. B) We saw elephants, giraffes and, zebras at the park. C) We saw elephants, giraffes and zebras at the park. D) We saw, elephants giraffes and zebras at the park. E) We saw elephants giraffes, and zebras, at the park.

9. Write the possessive form for: the opinion belonging to Sara (one person).

10. Explain the difference between 'whose' and 'who's', giving one correct example sentence for each.

11. Punctuate this sentence correctly: 'No Mr Evans I have not finished yet.'

12. Which sentence correctly uses an apostrophe to show joint possession? A) Ben and Lucys' project was excellent. B) Ben's and Lucy's project was excellent. C) Ben and Lucy's project was excellent. D) Bens and Lucys project was excellent. E) Ben and Lucy project's was excellent.

13. Rewrite this list of adjectives with correct commas: 'It was a bright warm cheerful morning.'

14. Explain why 'the babies' room' is correct but 'the baby's' room' (with an extra apostrophe after the s) would be wrong.

15. Select ALL that apply. Which of these are correctly punctuated sentences with a comma before a coordinating conjunction joining two main clauses? A) The bell rang, and the pupils left. B) The bell rang and, the pupils left. C) I was hungry but I waited. D) I was hungry, but I waited. E) The show ended, the audience clapped.

## Standard / Advanced (15 questions)

1. Correct and explain every comma error in: 'The author who wrote the trilogy gave a long fascinating, talk to the students who were thrilled to meet her.'

2. Explain the difference between 'the cat's toy', 'the cats' toy' and 'the cats toy', and say which is NOT standard English.

3. Which sentence correctly uses a comma to separate a non-essential (extra) clause from essential information? A) The painting that won the award, hangs in the hall. B) The painting, that won the award hangs in the hall. C) The painting, which won the award, hangs in the hall. D) The painting which, won the award hangs in the hall. E) The painting which won the award hangs, in the hall.

4. Rewrite correctly, fixing both a missing comma and a misused apostrophe: 'Its odd that the sister's coats were left outside last night.'

5. Select ALL that apply. Which of the following show CORRECT use of an apostrophe for possession? A) the puppies' basket B) the ladie's shoes C) the witness's statement D) the boys' changing room E) Charles' hat (also accept Charles's hat)

6. Explain when 'it's' should be used instead of 'its', giving two example sentences — one for each meaning of 'it's'.

7. Which sentence is correctly punctuated with commas around a parenthetical (interrupting) phrase? A) My brother, a keen footballer will join the team. B) My brother a keen footballer, will join the team. C) My brother, a keen footballer, will join the team. D) My brother a keen, footballer will join the team. E) My, brother a keen footballer will join the team.

8. Explain why 'the team's bus' is correct for one team, but 'the teams' bus' would mean something different. Give the meaning of each.

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**9.** Correct this sentence, which contains two comma errors and one apostrophe error: 'My neighbours who moved here last year are friendly and theyre always offering to lend us the dogs lead.'

**10.** Which sentence correctly punctuates direct speech with a comma before the reporting clause? A) 'We should leave soon' said Maya. B) 'We should leave soon,' said Maya. C) 'We should leave soon', said Maya. D) 'We should leave soon.' said Maya. E) 'We should leave, soon' said Maya.

**11.** Explain the rule for forming the possessive of a singular noun that already ends in s (e.g. Charles, the actress), and give one correctly punctuated example.

**12.** Select ALL that apply. Which sentences correctly use a comma to mark off a fronted adverbial or subordinate clause? A) In spite of the delay the train arrived safely. B) In spite of the delay, the train arrived safely. C) Having waited an hour, we finally boarded. D) Having waited an hour we finally boarded. E) As the sun set, the sky turned orange.

**13.** Write one sentence containing a list of three adjectives, correctly comma-separated, AND one possessive apostrophe used correctly, then underline both features.

**14.** Explain why 'the players' kit' and 'the player's kit' have different meanings, giving the meaning of each.

**15.** Correct this passage, which has three punctuation errors (two commas, one apostrophe): 'Although the forecast was bad the captains boat set off, because the sailors who had trained for months wanted to compete.'

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